WILDLIFE DISEASES

Situation Report Q1/26

Period covered: Jan – Mar 2026

This report provides an update on wildlife disease situation, according to the information submitted on listed diseases through the World Animal Health Information System of the World Organisation for Animal Health (WAHIS).

A general introduction of the scope and objective of this report, as well as global level of wildlife disease surveillance activities, can be found on Wildlife Health - WOAH - World Organisation for Animal Health.

Key messages

- During the reporting period, **55 countries and territories** reported **6,943 outbreaks** and **10,359 cases** of WOAH-listed diseases in wildlife. Cases related to **11 diseases** were reported in **152 different wildlife species, 12.5%** of which (19 species) are classified as threatened (Vulnerable, Endangered, or Near Threatened) by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.

- As in previous reports, **African swine fever (ASF)** and **highly pathogenic avian influenza (HPAI)** dominated the reporting of exceptional events in wildlife, jointly accounting for **92.8%** of all outbreaks (HPAI: 3,255; ASF: 3,188), concentrated mainly in **Europe** (91.8% of all outbreaks). **Classical swine fever (CSF)** emerged as the third most-reported disease (451 outbreaks, 6.5% of the total) — a disease not featured in the previous report — warranting continued monitoring. All other diseases (rabies, West Nile fever, bluetongue, *Bonamia ostreae*, foot-and-mouth disease, *Batrachochytrium salamandrivorans*, *Brucella suis*, and theileriosis) each recorded fewer than 35 outbreaks.

- Cases in the **19 threatened species** represented only **0.4% of the total number of cases** notified during the period (41 of 10,359). HPAI accounted for the large majority of this impact, affecting **18 of the 19 threatened species**, including four classified as Endangered (Saker Falcon, Bank Cormorant, Black Harrier, and Grey Parrot). No Critically Endangered species were affected this period.

- Foot-and-mouth disease (FMD) was the only other disease to affect a threatened species this period, affecting one Endangered species — the **Mountain Gazelle**, in Israel. Unlike the previous reporting period, anthrax, Aujeszky's disease, Echinococcus granulosus, and heartwater were not reported in wildlife this quarter.

- From a public health perspective, **5 of the 11 diseases** reported this period are classified as zoonoses (HPAI, rabies, West Nile fever, and Brucella suis as Common; FMD as Minimal).

Recent updates (January – March 2026)

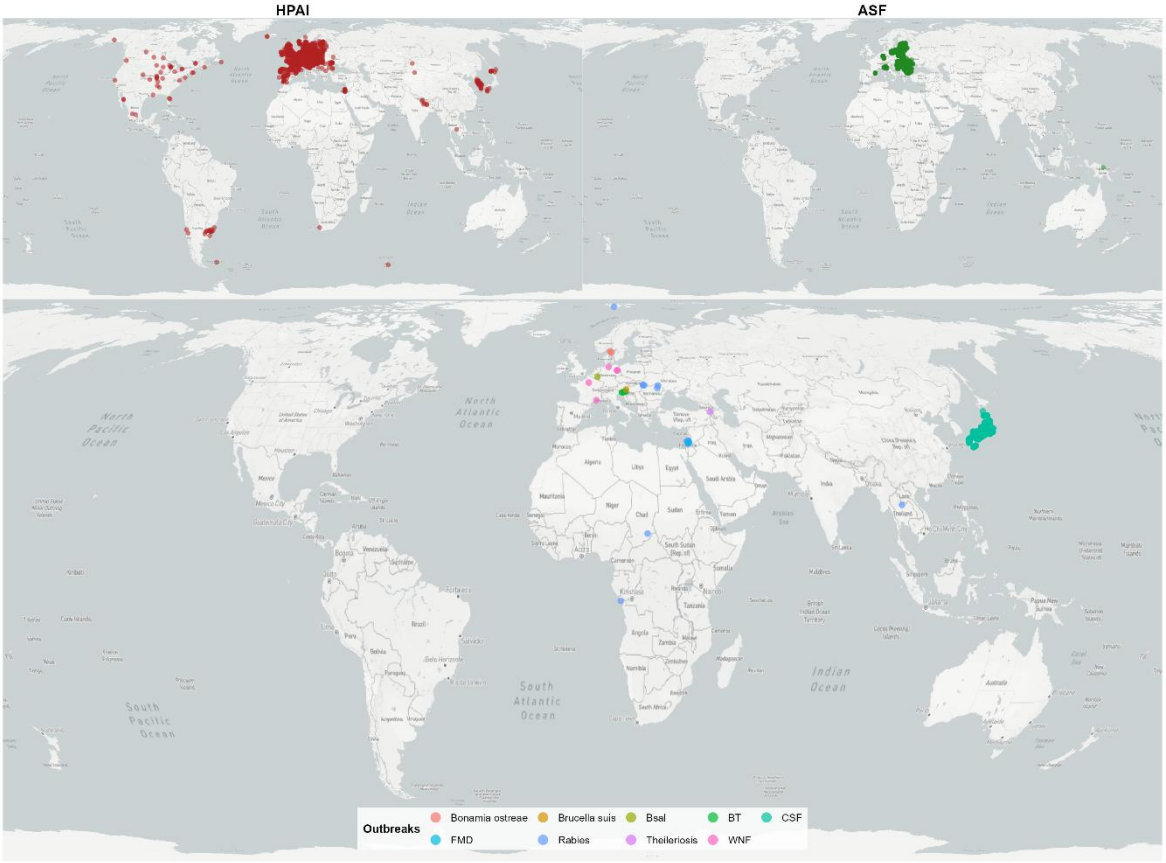
In total, **6,943 new outbreaks** with **10,359 cases** of exceptional disease events in terrestrial wildlife (based on the criteria listed in Article 1.1.3. of the WOAH Terrestrial Animal Health Code – Figure 1) were notified to the World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) during the reporting period, through the World Animal Health Information System (WAHIS). Other cases in wildlife have been reported during the period via email according to the provision of article 1.1.5 of the Terrestrial Animal Health Code, and related information can be consulted in the dedicated dashboard, not part of this report. This report does not include cases in wild animals from areas where the disease situation is declared as stable, as well as diseases that do not appear among WOAH-listed diseases.

Outbreaks were reported in Africa, in the Americas, in Asia and the Pacific, and in Europe for **eleven diseases** (see Figures 1 and 2). Specifically, Members reported infection with African swine fever virus (ASF), infection with *Batrachochytrium salamandrivorans* (Bsal), *Bonamia ostreae*, infection with bluetongue virus (BT), infection with *Brucella suis*, infection with Classical swine fever virus (CSF), infection with foot and mouth disease virus (FMD), infection of birds other than poultry—including wild birds—with influenza A viruses of high pathogenicity (HPAI), infection with rabies virus (rabies), theileriosis (infection with *Theileria lestoquardi*, *T. luwenshuni* and *T. uilenbergi*), and West Nile Fever (WNF).

As shown in Figure 2, most outbreaks **(92%)** were reported in **Europe**, possibly because of more extensive wildlife surveillance or reporting activities. Most of the outbreaks reported in Europe and the Americas were associated with the presence or spread of **HPAI and ASF**; in Asia and the Pacific, however, outbreaks were dominated by Classical swine fever (451 of 509 outbreaks in the region), reflecting a large CSF cluster in wild boar. The diseases with the highest global number of outbreaks reported were, as in previous reports, HPAI (3,255 outbreaks) and ASF (3,188 outbreaks).

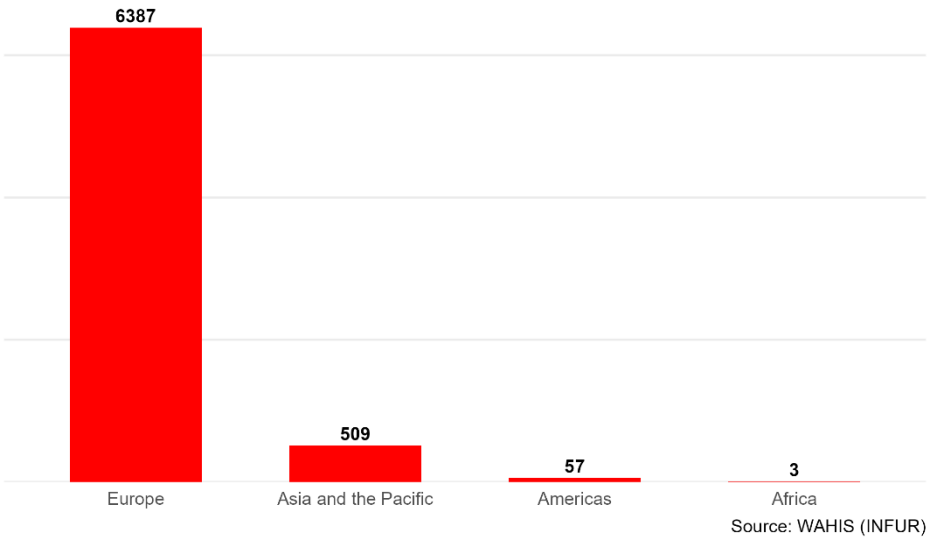
Cases of these diseases were reported in 152 different wild species (see Tables 1 and 2).

Figure 1. New outbreaks of exceptional disease events reported during the period in wildlife. Due to the large number of their outbreaks, ASF and HPAI are presented in a separate map (ASF = infection with African swine fever virus; Bsal = infection with Batrachochytrium salamandrivorans; BT = infection with bluetongue virus; CSF = infection with Classical swine fever virus; FMD = infection with foot and mouth disease virus; HPAI = Infection of birds other than poultry, including wild birds, with influenza A viruses of high pathogenicity; WNF = West Nile fever)



Source: WAHIS (INFUR)

Figure 2. Number of outbreaks reported during the period by world region



Source: WAHIS (INFUR)

Table 1. Number of outbreaks reported by disease and information on zoonotic character of the disease[1].

Disease	Outbreaks reported	Zoonotic disease
HPAI	3267	Common
ASF	3188	No
CSF	451	No
Rabies	33	Common
BT	5	No
WNF	5	Common
Bonamia ostreae	2	No
FMD	2	Minimal
Brucella suis	1	Common
Bsal	1	No
Theileriosis	1	No

Table 2. Number of cases reported by animal species; conservation status of each species, based on IUCN Red List of threatened species (database accessed on 08 September2026). This table provides the diseases that affected species with threatened status. The full list of species reported is available on demand.

Disease	Cases	Species (common name)	Reporting countries/ territories	Conservation Status *
FMD	1	Mountain Gazelle	Israel	EN
HPAI	13	Eurasian Curlew	Belgium, Denmark, Germany, Netherlands, Sweden, United Kingdom	NT
HPAI	5	Common Eider	Denmark, Germany, Norway, United States of America	NT
HPAI	4	Lesser White-fronted Goose	Germany	VU
HPAI	3	Saker Falcon	Hungary	EN
HPAI	2	Atlantic Puffin	United Kingdom	VU
HPAI	1	Bank Cormorant	United Kingdom	EN
HPAI	1	Black Harrier	United Kingdom	EN
HPAI	1	Black-faced Spoonbill	Japan	VU
HPAI	1	Black-legged Kittiwake	United Kingdom	VU
HPAI	1	Cinereous Vulture	Korea (Rep. of)	NT
HPAI	1	Common Pochard	Austria	VU
HPAI	1	Eurasian Oystercatcher	Germany	NT
HPAI	1	Greater Rhea	Germany	NT
HPAI	1	Grey Parrot	United States of America	EN

[1] This assessment is based on the definition of zoonosis documented in the Tripartite Guide to Addressing Zoonotic Diseases in Countries: "infectious diseases that can be spread between animals and humans; can be spread by food, water, fomites, or vectors."

Disease	Cases	Species (common name)	Reporting countries/ territories	Conservation Status *
HPAI	1	Hawaiian Goose	United States of America	NT
HPAI	1	Long-tailed Duck	Sweden	VU
HPAI	1	Ruddy Turnstone	Netherlands	NT
HPAI	1	Snowy Owl	Canada	VU

*NT=Near threatened; VU=vulnerable; EN= endangered; CR= critically endangered

Global and regional impact

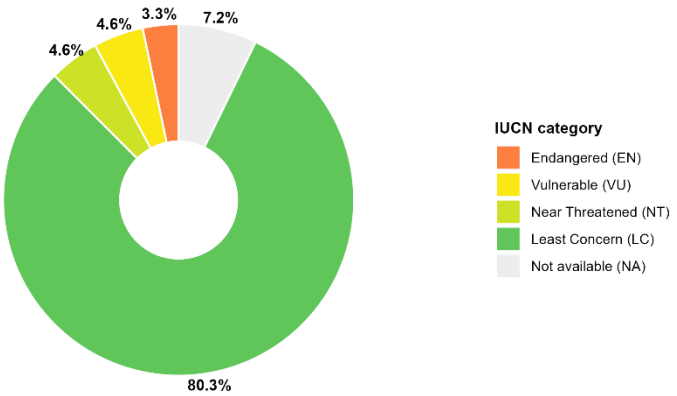
Reporting and impact on biodiversity

Out of the **152** wild species for which cases were reported, **19 (12.5%)** have a threatened status according to the IUCN classification. They constitute **0.4%** of cases reported in wildlife over the period. Species threatened with extinction are less numerous and rely on a limited geographic distribution, and therefore, their population may not recover from a significant disease outbreak. No diseases in species classified as Critically Endangered (CR) were reported during this period; five species are classified as "Endangered" (EN), seven as "Vulnerable" (VU), and seven as "Near Threatened" (NT) (see Figure 3 and Table 2).

Of the 11 diseases reported, HPAI is the one that affected the highest number of threatened species **(18 out of 19)**; foot and mouth disease (FMD) affected the remaining one - the Endangered Mountain Gazelle, in Israel. Unlike the previous reporting period, anthrax, bluetongue, and Echinococcus granulosus were not detected in any threatened species this period.

The detection of HPAI in species with a vulnerable conservation status is a common and consistent finding in our analysis, highlighting the potentially detrimental impact of this disease on biodiversity conservation, due to additional mortality. Further scientific studies, such as a longitudinal wildlife population assessment, would be needed to measure the impact of the disease on these populations.

Figure 3. Percentage of reported species falling under the different IUCN categories



Source: WAHIS (INFUR) / IUCN Red List

Considering only species with "Endangered (EN)" IUCN status, HPAI was detected in four species

— Saker Falcon in Hungary, Bank Cormorant in the United Kingdom, Black Harrier in the United Kingdom, and Grey Parrot in the United States of America — and foot and mouth disease (FMD) was detected in one Mountain Gazelle in Israel. Some current detections in endangered species have occurred in zoo animals. However, to illustrate the potential impact of the occurrence of HPAI and FMD in these species, it is important to note that:

- The Saker Falcon has suffered a substantial population decline, driven primarily by illegal trapping for the falconry trade, along with electrocution on power infrastructure and secondary poisoning from rodenticides. The species has an exceptionally broad range spanning Central and Eastern Europe through Central Asia to Mongolia and China, wintering across the Middle East, South Asia, and East Africa, but even this wide distribution has not offset the sustained decline driven by targeted trapping pressure.
- The Bank Cormorant is endemic to a narrow coastal strip of Namibia and South Africa and has declined from tens of thousands of breeding pairs historically to a few thousand today, largely due to reduced prey availability from commercial purse-seine fishing depleting sardine and anchovy stocks, compounded by disturbance, guano harvesting, and oil pollution at its limited breeding colonies.
- The Black Harrier is one of the rarest raptors in the world, with a global population estimated at well under 1,500 mature individuals, confined almost entirely to the fynbos and grassland biomes of southern Africa. Its restricted range is under continuing pressure from agricultural transformation, urban expansion, and secondary poisoning.
- The Grey Parrot has experienced steep declines across its Central and West African forest range, driven mainly by unsustainable capture for the international wild-bird trade, compounded by ongoing deforestation, leaving many populations locally extirpated.
- The Mountain Gazelle persists in small, increasingly fragmented subpopulations across parts of the Middle East, threatened by habitat loss to urbanization and agriculture, competition with livestock, and hunting pressure.

In all these examples, disease can create an additional burden to already existing population pressures through additional mortality, with a potentially disproportionate effect given how small and fragmented several of these populations already are.

Reporting and impact on public health

HPAI has a recognised zoonotic potential, and the disease is by far the most reported one in terms of outbreaks in wild birds (3,255 outbreaks this period). In addition, the number of cases in mammals has increased in the past years, meaning the virus has adapted to infect mammals more efficiently. This situation is worrying from a public health perspective.

Some outbreaks of the other common zoonoses (rabies, West Nile Fever, and infection with Brucella suis) were reported in 11 countries (Austria, Chad, Congo (Rep. of the), France, Germany, Hungary, Israel, Moldova, Norway, Romania, Thailand).

From a public health perspective, it is worth mentioning the first occurrence of rabies in wildlife in five countries during this period: Chad, Congo (Rep. of the), Israel, Moldova, and Romania. No first occurrences were identified for West Nile Fever (reported in France and Germany, both previously affected) or Brucella suis (Austria, also previously affected).

Reporting and impact on domestic animal health and welfare

During the reporting period, most of the outbreaks of non-zoonotic diseases were related to the occurrence of ASF in wild boars, overwhelmingly concentrated in Europe (3,187 of 3,188 ASF outbreaks, with a single outbreak reported in Asia and the Pacific). ASF is one of the major animal diseases currently threatening global livestock and food security (for more information, see the ASF situation reports). A recent publication highlights that 39% of infected wild boar populations originated from outbreak farms, and 61% from other infected wild boar populations, with favourable habitat exhibiting higher susceptibility and infectivity than unfavourable habitats. In addition, Classical swine fever (CSF) - not previously featured in this report - was the second most-reported non-zoonotic disease this period (451 outbreaks, 12.4% of the non-zoonotic total), entirely concentrated in wild boar populations in Asia and the Pacific. As with ASF, wild boar act as a persistent reservoir enabling spillover to domestic pig farms: a study of Japan's 2018-2019 CSF epidemic estimated that a farm located within 5 km of a CSF-positive wild boar detection faced an infection risk of more than 5% within 28 days (Hayama et al., 2019, cited in Isoda et al., 2020). Together, ASF and CSF accounted for nearly all (99.8%) non-zoonotic outbreaks reported this quarter, underlining that wild boar remain the primary wildlife reservoir of concern for swine disease spillover risk to the domestic pig sector and associated food security implications, now spanning both Europe (ASF) and Asia and the Pacific (CSF). Regarding the occurrence of HPAI, the dynamics of the disease at the poultry/wildlife interface can also impact food security (for additional information see the HPAI situation reports).

Global evolution of diseases in wildlife

This section provides a global wildlife disease dynamics from 2024 to the date this report. Figure 4 provides an overview of the monthly dynamics of the number of outbreaks split by main diseases and regions.

Overall pattern of outbreaks: winter waves are identified, each one bigger than the previous (Figure 5 - Panel A). Outbreaks showed strong seasonality: in particular, two important winter peaks (Nov–Feb each year) separated by more quiet summer period (Apr–Sep, generally under 300 outbreaks/month). The first wave peaked around Jan–Feb 2025 at ~1,600 outbreaks/month; the second, covering the current reporting period, was larger; from ~600 in Oct 2025 to a peak of ~2,900 in Feb 2026, nearly double the prior winter's peak.

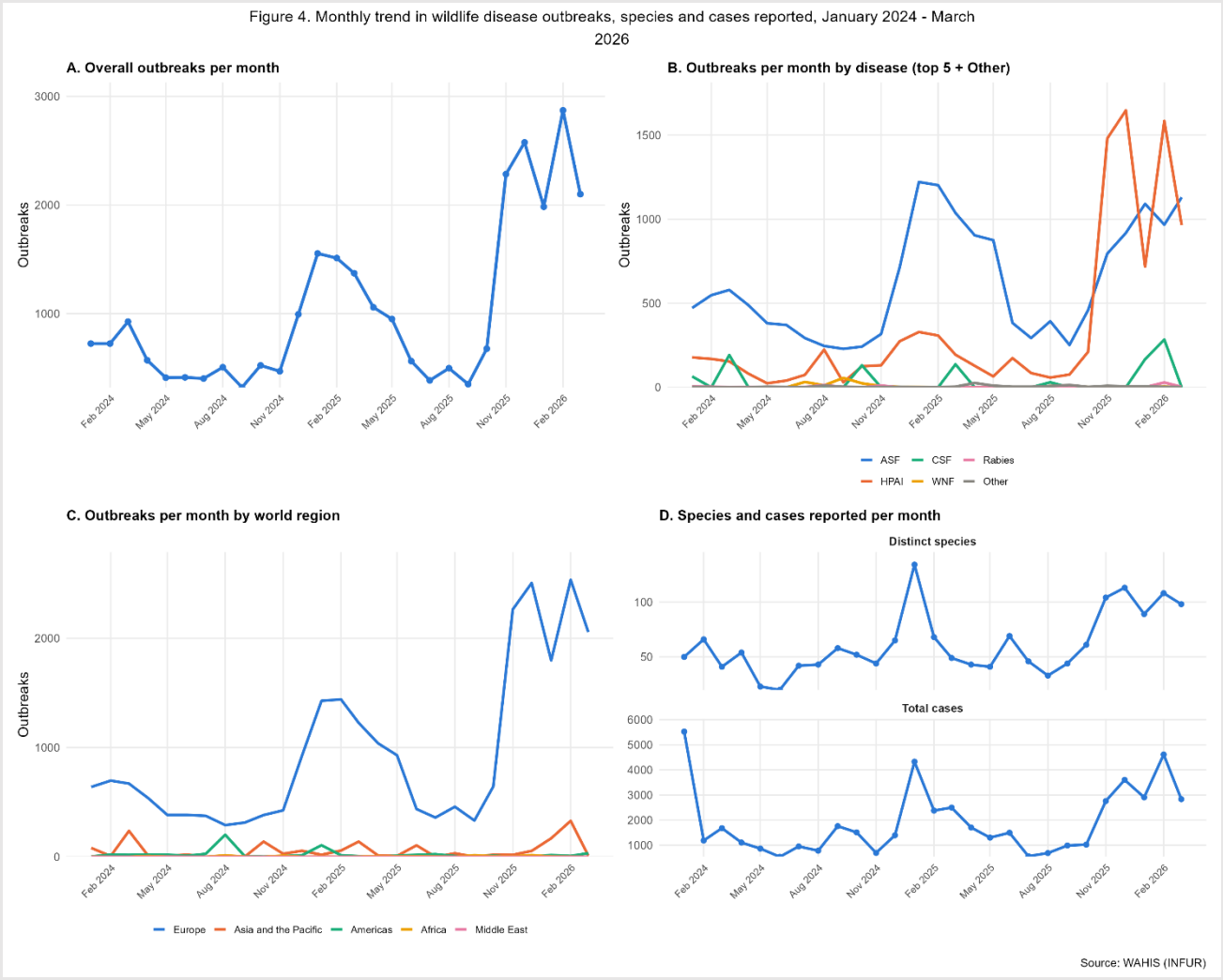
The first wave (winter 2024–25) was almost entirely driven by ASF, which alone reached ~1,200/month while every other disease stayed under ~350. The second, larger wave was very different and driven by HPAI, since Nov 2025. During the same period, ASF outbreaks started to increase (~2,100 in Mar 2026). CSF contributed significantly to the outbreak dynamics in some specific months. All the other diseases (e.g. Rabies, WNF) represented a minor number of outbreaks.

From a geographic point of view, the regional breakdown was dominated by reports from Europe. Asia and the Pacific showed a modest rise from Nov 2025 (~300–400/month), due to CSF. The Americas had one isolated peak (~250) around Aug 2024; Africa, and the Middle East remained near zero across the full period. It is important to note that reporting bias might alter this geographic picture.

The number of different wildlife species affected each month (i.e. distinct species) and **total case counts** exhibited similar winter wave patterns: species counts peaked at ~130 during the first wave (Jan/Feb 2025) and again at ~90–120 in Q1 2026. Total cases peaked in a similar way (~4,300 in early 2025, ~4,800 around Feb 2026), with a global baseline of around 800–2,000/month.

Q1 2026 represented the largest of the two recurring winter peaks since 2024, with the dynamics shifting from an ASF-driven event last year to a joint ASF/HPAI event this year, still concentrated almost entirely in Europe.

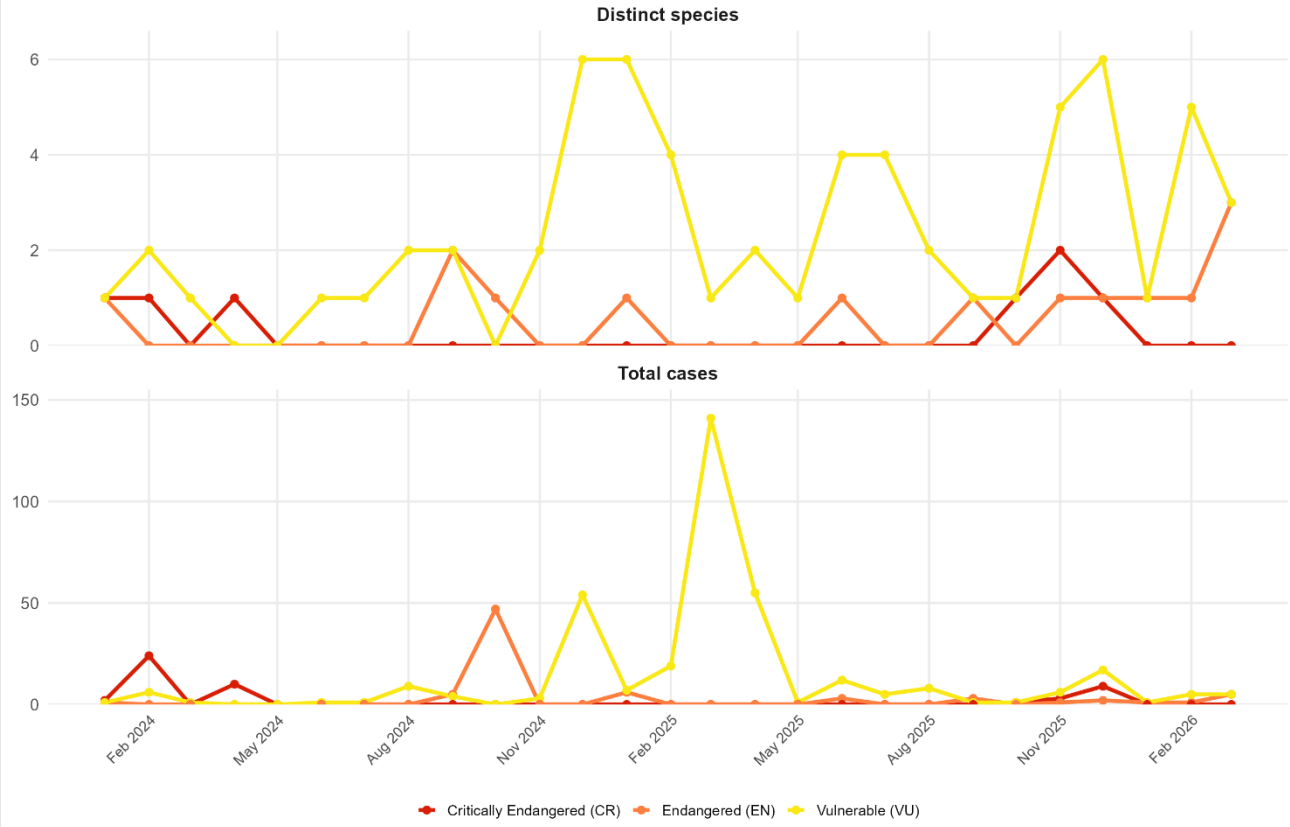
Figure 4. Monthly trend in wildlife disease outbreaks, species and cases reported, January 2024 - March 2026



Trends of reported species with either CR, EN, or VU status are reported in figure 5. **Vulnerable (VU) species dominated the trend.** Distinct VU species reported per month ranged from 0–2 in early 2024 up to recurring peaks of 4–6 (Dec 2024–Jan 2025, Jun–Jul 2025, Nov–Dec 2025, and again Feb 2026). CR and EN, by contrast, were smore sporadic.

The CR/EN/VU trend did not follow the overall outbreak peak observed in Figure 4 Figure 4 showed the largest wave in Feb 2026, while the biggest threatened-species case peaked (~140) in Feb/Mar 2025. The Q1 2026 threatened-species case counts were, in comparison, quite modest. This means that the large ASF/HPAI peak this quarter appears to be affecting mostly common numerous and non-threatened wildlife populations (e.g. wild boar, common waterfowl), and no species of conservation concern. On the other hand, it is important to always keep in mind that endangered species are less numerous and may be underrepresented in official statistics. However, every loss is significant in a very small population.

Figure 5. Monthly trend in threatened (CR/EN/VU) species and cases reported in wildlife outbreaks, January 2024 - March 2026



Source: WAHIS (INFUR) / IUCN Red List

More information and resources

- Statement on avian influenza and mammals
- Avian Influenza and Wildlife: Risk Management for People Working with Wild Birds
- Continued expansion of HPAI H5 in wildlife in South America and incursion into the Antarctic region (OFFLU statement)
- Considerations for emergency vaccination of wild birds against high pathogenicity avian influenza in specific situations
- African swine fever in wild boar ecology and biosecurity
- African swine fever awareness and technical resources
- In-country wildlife disease surveillance report 2021
- In-country wildlife data management survey dashboard 2023

For any press inquiry on diseases in wildlife, you can email us at media@woah.org

Complete list of species for which cases were reported in this report is available on demand at epi@woah.org.

To contact the wildlife team at WOAH use wildlife@woah.org.